

M03 MENTAL HEALTH SERVICES | O (MAX : 4 PT)

Intent : To increase awareness of mental health conditions, as well as offer supportive workplace services and accommodations for those living with such conditions.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to support occupant mental health through the provision of programs and resources.

Issue : Obtaining appropriate treatment for mental health conditions remains a global barrier. It is estimated that 76-85% of people in low- and middle-income countries and 30-50% in high-income countries receive no treatment, and those who do receive help often face issues with poor quality care.¹² Compared to other illnesses, mental health conditions have longer delays in treatment onset.^{3,4} Many factors contribute to this gap, including a lack of equity in healthcare coverage between benefits for mental health, substance abuse and addiction, and benefits for other medical needs, as well as insufficient mental health promotion to increase awareness and minimize the stigma associated with mental health conditions.^{5,6} This lack of treatment has major public health and economic consequences: individuals with depression miss an average of 4.8 workdays and experience 11.5 days of reduced productivity in a three-month period, and people living with mental health conditions are overall less likely to receive high quality medical care and preventive health services (e.g., immunizations, cancer screening, tobacco cessation support).^{7,8} Furthermore, many individuals who go through emergency situations (e.g., natural disaster) experience psychological distress, resulting in depression, anxiety, feelings of hopelessness, fatigue, irritability or anger.^{9,10} These impacts can be exacerbated by added stressors during emergencies such as social isolation, economic hardship or grief, reinforcing the need for adequate access to mental health services.^{9,10}

Solutions : Equitable access to screening and mental health services can help encourage care utilization, support early diagnosis and overall mitigate poor mental health outcomes.⁵ Enhanced social support and adjustments to the work environment can also help enable a successful return for employees coming back from leave due to a mental health condition.^{11,12} Additionally, providing access to mental health services during and after emergency situations, such as psychological first aid, crisis counseling and bereavement counseling, is critical to supporting employee short-term recovery and long-term productivity, functioning and well-being.^{9,10,13,14}

PART 1 OFFER MENTAL HEALTH SCREENING (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project or organization makes a clinical assessment screening tool (e.g., self-assessment, screening tool administered by a professional) for common mental health conditions available to all employees and students either in-person or virtually, at no additional cost. The tool meets the following requirements:

- a. Addresses, at minimum, stress, depression, anxiety and substance use.
- b. Provides confidentiality by leveraging a licensed mental health professional, third party organization, online screening or health insurance offering.
- c. Includes directed feedback and/or guidance on interpretation of results and provides next steps for those who screen positive or at-risk.^{6,15}

PART 2 OFFER MENTAL HEALTH SERVICES (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project or organization makes a mental health benefits policy available to all eligible employees that meets following requirements:

- a.
 - Mental health support is available at no additional cost or subsidized and covers the following at a minimum:
 1. Clinical screening and referral to licensed mental health professionals and support resources.⁶
 2. Inpatient treatment (e.g., residential programs, hospitalization).⁶
 3. Outpatient treatment, including options for telemental health services (e.g., in-person therapy, online therapy).^{6,16}
 4. Prescription medication.⁶
- b. Mental health parity in health service coverage.⁶
- c. Information on benefits coverage and how to access mental health services and community resources is easily and confidentially available (e.g., via a health portal or employee website).⁶
- d. Confidential benefits consultation with people who are clearly identified and qualified (e.g., benefits counselor, human resources representative) is made available.

PART 3 OFFER EMPLOYEE MENTAL HEALTH SUPPORT (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project or organization has a mental health policy and the benefits within are made available to all employees without a need to disclose the underlying health reason. The mental health policy meets the following requirements:

- a. Sick leave may be used for mental health needs (e.g., appointments).^{12,17,18}
- b. Short- or long-term leave may be used for mental health needs, with the option of a phased integration back to work after returning from leave.^{18,19}
- c. Increased interpersonal support (e.g., manager support with prioritizing and managing workloads, increased frequency of one-on-one check-ins).¹²
- d. Adjustment of work schedule to support mental health needs (e.g., appointments, start/end times).^{12,17,18}
- e. Adjustment of the workplace to support mental health (e.g., moving a workstation to a busier or a quieter area, providing a quiet space for breaks, providing earplugs or headphones, increasing personal space, providing the

ability to work from home).^{12,17,18}

PART 4 B SUPPORT MENTAL HEALTH RECOVERY (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Projects offer mental health services and resources to support recovery from a traumatic event to all employees at no additional cost or subsidized, on-site, in-person within 400 m of the project boundary or virtually, including at least three of the following:

- a. Crisis counseling or trauma-focused psychotherapy with qualified mental health professionals.
- b. Psychological first aid (PFA) training offered to all employees and/or required for manager-level employees.²⁰
- c. Bereavement counseling and materials on coping with grief, including resources for returning to work after a loss.
- d. Information on benefits coverage and how to access additional mental health services, made conveniently and confidentially accessible to employees.

Note : This feature is a beta strategy and has an additional documentation requirement (beta feature feedback form). The feedback form supports IWBI in developing new features that are effective and applicable to projects around the world.

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